



— PRODUCTBEACON RESEARCH · WEM RADAR

Salesforce: fewer seats, more spending. California targets chatbots.

Weekly summary · 20 September 2026

By Yohay Etsion · former NICE product leader (Recording/WFO), 2008–2021 · public sources only · full disclosure on the last slide





— THE SEATS

Salesforce tells investors fewer seats can mean more revenue.

- Salesforce describes customers adopting AI agents in support “with some seat optimization.” It reports they spend 1.5 to 2 times more overall.
- Help for employees is sold as a higher-priced seat. Agents serving customers are charged by credits, usage, outcomes or a spending commitment.
- Salesforce reports premium seats rose from 1% to 5% of licences, with a 60 to 80% price uplift.
- It gave no standalone Agentforce revenue figure and repeated its revenue guidance.

Our view: Five9 made the same argument on 11 September. Both describe their own customers, and neither figure is audited.

SOURCES Salesforce, 16 Sep · Investing.com, 11 Sep



— THE LAUNCH

Salesforce's contact-centre service is due in October.

- CX Today reports Salesforce said on stage that its contact-centre service goes live in October. Salesforce has not published a release confirming the date.
- The service combines telephony, customer records and AI agents in one system. Salesforce first announced it in March.
- Salesforce reports its own help agent, Casey, has resolved five million conversations on its help site.
- Salesforce now sells Fin, acquired on 10 September, as a named agent beside Casey.

Watch: whether the October launch arrives with a price.

SOURCES CX Today, 16 Sep · Salesforce, 11 Sep



— THE PRICING

Seats with AI credits included are spreading.

- Salesforce's three editions list at \$195, \$395 and \$550 per user per month. Each includes a yearly allowance of AI credits.
- Moor Insights & Strategy calls the bundle "an interesting hedge." Salesforce kept its credit system and its \$2 per conversation price.
- MarketBeat reports HubSpot told analysts it will keep moving to seats and credits, with a test in the Nordics and Benelux.
- No tracked vendor returned from per-outcome pricing to per-seat pricing.

Our view: outcome pricing is not retreating. Large vendors are wrapping AI usage inside a seat price.

SOURCES Salesforce, 3 Sep · Moor Insights & Strategy, 18 Sep · MarketBeat, 18 Sep



— THE LAW

California bill: reach a human within 15 minutes.

- AB 1609 reached the Governor on 14 September. It covers businesses with more than \$500 million in yearly revenue.
- A covered business may not present a chatbot as a human. It must make a good-faith effort to connect a customer to a human within 15 minutes.
- Penalties reach \$5,000, then \$10,000. Public prosecutors enforce it; customers cannot sue.
- It is neither signed nor vetoed. Like the three workplace-AI bills, it becomes law unless vetoed by 30 September.

Our view: this would be the first law we track that sets a minimum for human availability in large contact centres.

SOURCES California Legislative Information, 14 Sep · Office of the Governor, 18 Sep



— THE ANALYTICS

CallMiner repositions around automation.

- CallMiner published its first press releases since 23 June. It now calls itself the leader in “CX automation powered by deep conversation intelligence.”
- Its survey with Vanson Bourne reports 99% of customer-service organisations use automation. Only 24% say it delivers very positive experiences. No sample size is given.
- CallMiner says Forrester named it a Strong Performer in customer-feedback platforms, its first appearance in that ranking.
- CX Today reports Cresta is a Contender in the same ranking.

Our view: conversation analytics is now being graded as an alternative to surveys.

SOURCES CallMiner, 15 Sep · CallMiner, 17 Sep · CX Today, 18 Sep



— THE BUYERS

Mercado Libre appears on two vendors' customer lists.

- Decagon opened a São Paulo office and named Mercado Libre as a customer for Portuguese-language voice agents. It gave no volumes.
- Wonderful published a Mercado Libre Mexico case study the same day. It reports roughly 99% of conversations handled without a person “in its first runs.”
- Sierra says it passed an independent audit against AIUC-1, a new safety standard for AI agents.
- Teneo AI cleared its debt by issuing its lender about 940 million new shares.

Our view: a large buyer is splitting work between vendors by use case and country.

SOURCES Decagon, 15 Sep · Wonderful, 15 Sep · Sierra, 17 Sep · Teneo AI, 16 Sep



— SOURCES

Sources behind this week's news.

Company announcements, official records and reporting:

COMPANY ANNOUNCEMENTS

Salesforce · CallMiner · Decagon · Wonderful · Sierra · Teneo AI

OFFICIAL SOURCES

California Legislative Information · Office of the Governor

ANALYST AND PRESS REPORTING

CX Today · Moor Insights & Strategy · MarketBeat · Investing.com

Source links and detailed citations accompany the full weekly summary.



— FULL DISCLOSURE

Seats remain the contract. People remain in the plan.

Two public vendors say seat numbers can fall while spending rises. California may require large companies to keep humans reachable. Buying and workforce decisions need to account for both people and AI.

→ **Read the full report**

productbeacon.agency/research/state-of-wem-2026

The author was employed by NICE from 9 April 2008 to 20 May 2021, including senior product-leadership responsibility for the Recording / Workforce-Optimization line of business, and remains bound by a confidentiality and trade-secret undertaking from that employment. The report relies solely on published material and contains no information derived from that employment. NICE is graded on the identical published-material rubric applied to every peer, no softer, no harsher, and was held under an adversarial cross-chapter read in both directions. The author holds no NICE equity and has no current commercial relationship with NICE.

Independent research. Public sources and vendors' own words. Interpretations are labelled as ours. Not investment advice.